



## TWELVE-MONTH PROGRESS REPORT

# Namibia: progress report, 2025-08-01 to 2026-08-21

Edition of 2026-08-21 • 129 systems and instruments tracked, 12 of them not held

*Compiled 2026-08-21 from the Data Landscapers source base. Sections follow the status report. Each opens with a movement ledger comparing the position at the start and end of the period, which runs to the date of issue rather than to the last month's close.*

Of 129 systems and instruments on this place's ledger, 63 changed position between 2025-08-01 and 2026-08-21, 35 did not, 19 carry no stated baseline, and 12 are **Not held** at both ends.

Shape check, run before the comparison: 123 sources for this place in the window — 27 in the earlier half (2025-08 to 2026-02), 96 in the later (2026-03 to 2026-08). The earlier half of the window is thin: this is a shorter comparison wearing a longer label, and the movement below rests mostly on the later half.

**Movement values.** *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

## Summary of the period

Namibia's twelve months to 6 August 2026 delivered networks and deferred statutes. Commercial fifth-generation service, a privately owned mobile network and 25 new towers all entered service inside the window ([launch account](#)); the Data Protection Bill missed a September 2025 tabling and the electronic signature regime missed a February 2026 deployment, and both are marked *Stalled* ([tabling announcement](#)).

The regulatory decision of the period was a refusal. A satellite operator's licence application went from pending, with a ministerial ownership exemption under review, to refused on 23 March 2026 and upheld on 22 June after 624 reconsideration requests were dismissed ([regulator account](#)).

Namibia is the one country in this batch with no coverage cliff: its base runs continuously across the window, so the ten rows carrying no baseline are genuinely unestablished positions rather than an artefact of when the wiki started reading.

# Infrastructure

## Connectivity

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                       | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | MOVEMENT  |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>Commercial 5G network</b>                                               | No active commercial 5G network (ministry, 2025-06-03)                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Live in Windhoek, Swakopmund and Walvis Bay; nationwide deployment stated as intended, phased and city-first                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | ADVANCED  |
| <b>Determination of dominant position in the telecommunications market</b> | 2016 determination (Government Gazette 6054, General Notice 214, 28 June 2016) defined the four priority markets carried forward in 2024: fixed and mobile call/SMS termination, wired end-user access, national data transmission, and wireless end-user access | 2024 determination names Telecom Namibia dominant in all four markets - alone in wired end-user access, with NamPower in national data transmission, with MTC in wireless end-user access, and with MTC, UCom Mobile, Paratus and Telepassport in call and SMS termination, termination being treated as a natural monopoly; CRAN describes its approach across all three exercises (2013, 2016, 2024) as one of minimal intervention | ADVANCED  |
| <b>First privately owned mobile network</b>                                | Announced, not launched (2025-08-19)                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | A national network live on long-term evolution and 5G; N\$600m invested in the network in the preceding year and N\$1.42bn in Namibian network infrastructure since 2018, company-reported                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | ADVANCED  |
| <b>Ministry strategic plan 2025-2030 and national ICT policy</b>           | None published                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | In force; priorities are affordable broadband and mobile coverage in rural and underserved areas, cybersecurity, data protection and electronic government; the policy names high data costs, limited infrastructure and unequal access as the barriers                                                                                                                                                                               | ADVANCED  |
| <b>Regional subsea and satellite integration agreement</b>                 | None published                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Signed by the state fixed operator with two Angolan counterparts, with the Namibian operator as landing party hosting Angolan equipment; scope covers design, integration, testing, commissioning and handover                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | ADVANCED  |
| <b>Starlink operating licence</b>                                          | An ownership-exemption bid under ministerial review; no licence; a November 2024 cease-and-desist in force                                                                                                                                                       | Licence and spectrum declined 2026-03-23 on three of six statutory criteria; 622 of 624 reconsideration requests failed the legal threshold and two were refused on merits; the operator's own request of 2026-06-08 was dismissed as out of time                                                                                                                                                                                     | CLOSED    |
| <b>Tower-siting engagement with traditional authorities</b>                | None published                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | The ministry, the regulator and three operators met the traditional authorities' trust on siting delays and costs; no agreement, instrument or timetable reported                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | ADVANCED  |
| <b>Twenty-five-tower programme</b>                                         | Not yet inaugurated (2025-08-01)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Twenty-five towers in service across nine regions at N\$40m in total, N\$1.6m each, company-reported                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | ADVANCED  |
| <b>51% Namibian ownership requirement</b>                                  | In force, with a foreign-ownership exemption bid under ministerial review                                                                                                                                                                                        | In force; no exemption granted, and the regulator held that wholly foreign ownership raises questions of jurisdiction, enforceability of compliance obligations and effective oversight                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | NO CHANGE |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | MOVEMENT                 |
|-----------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| <b>CRAN Integrated Annual Report</b>                | Integrated Annual Report 2024 (approved 2024-09-06, year to 31 March 2024): a funding proposal secured a N\$115 million, three-year Universal Service Fund commitment from the Government of Namibia; broadband coverage of schools rose 31.5 points to 81.5% and of clinics 38.9 points to 88.9%; total assets N\$277.9 million, up N\$29.6 million | Integrated Annual Report 2025 (approved 2025-08-07, year to 31 March 2025): the Universal Service Fund's governance framework was approved and the Fund launched 2025-03-19 with the N\$115 million MICT commitment; a first bidding round awarded nine sites to MTC with almost N\$31 million capital subsidy across Kunene, Kavango East, Kavango West, Ohangwena and Oshikoto, with free internet for schools and clinics on the new sites for seven years; revenue fell 23% to 15.5% below budget, operating expenditure rose 42% to N\$143.1 million, and a N\$32.8 million surplus became a N\$25.5 million loss; 4G population coverage 91% and an ITU ICT Development Index of 73.2% are separately stated                                                                                     | NO CHANGE                |
| <b>Regulator coverage and subscriber statistics</b> | Published to 2023 data                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Published inside the sector market reports: 4G population coverage 85% in 2022, with six of Namibia's 14 regions below 80% and Kunene lowest at 41%; 456 of 1,380 schools and 84 of 452 health facilities without 4G coverage in 2022; about 2,000,000 of 2,900,000 mobile SIM cards actively used for internet access in 2022; and state influence over 87% of telecommunication assets and 83% of sector revenue in 2022, moving to 82% and 80% in 2023; the 2023 edition separately gives 4G population coverage of 88.4%, FTTH at 27% of fixed broadband subscribers (more than double its 2018 share), a 6% fall in active SIM cards, and a rise from 46th to 8th in African 1GB-affordability ranking between Q1 2022 and Q1 2023, which CRAN attributes to its own broadband-price consultation | NO CHANGE                |
| <b>Tax relief on fourth-generation devices</b>      | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Proposed; no fiscal instrument, budget line or ministerial response published, against an operator-reported utilisation close to 50% across about 74 enabled towers in the region                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

Data Storage

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                           | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                           | MOVEMENT                 |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| <b>National and public data centre</b>                                         | None published           | A concept note and project proposal directed to the ministry and the Office of the Prime Minister; no site, capacity, cost or date published at 2026-08-06                              | ADVANCED, NO DATES SET   |
| <b>Vendor-built national data centre for artificial-intelligence workloads</b> | None published           | A vendor building smart-city solutions and a data centre with the ICT and home affairs ministries; China committed CNY 98,000,000, given by the source as about US\$14.4m on 2026-07-08 | ADVANCED                 |
| <b>National Digital Strategy</b>                                               | Published August 2025    | In force; the national data centre it calls for was still at concept-note stage at 2025-09-22                                                                                           | NO CHANGE                |
| <b>Commercial data centres in operation</b>                                    | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | One operator-run facility and one run by an aerospace company with a national university operating commercially                                                                         | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

Technical Capacity

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                 | AT 2025-08-01  | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                   | MOVEMENT |
|------------------------------------------------------|----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>Capacity committed to the Angolan counterpart</b> | None published | 1.0 Tbps initial dedicated transmission capacity on the subsea system, per the signed agreement | ADVANCED |

## Cybersecurity

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                            | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | MOVEMENT                              |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| <b>Banking fraud losses</b>                                                     | About N\$8.7m a year (2020, central bank)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | N\$73.9m for 2025, with N\$65m lost between January and October 2025                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | REGRESSED                             |
| <b>Detected vulnerabilities and cyber events</b>                                | 2,231,970 vulnerabilities and 1.7m attacks over calendar 2025, up about 37% year on year                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | 513,921 vulnerabilities and 161,547 events in April to June 2026, up 39.8% and 56.7% on the prior quarter                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | REGRESSED                             |
| <b>Fraud and cybersecurity summit</b>                                           | Did not exist                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Convened by the ICT ministry with the central bank, the bankers' association, the incident response team and an industry cyber council; no second edition reported                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | ADVANCED                              |
| <b>Government-sector incident response team and security operations centres</b> | None published                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Approved as the central authority coordinating incidents across government, with the Office of the Prime Minister directed to coordinate phased implementation; no establishment, budget or timetable reported                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | ADVANCED, APPROVED<br>NOT ESTABLISHED |
| <b>NAM-CSIRT cybersecurity landscape report</b>                                 | Inaugural report (dated by proxy to January 2025, covering calendar 2024): Namibia scored 36.93 on the ITU Global Cybersecurity Index 2024 (Tier 4 Evolving), up from 11.47 in 2020; 2,727,913 vulnerabilities and five ransomware victims recorded for calendar 2024; NAM-CSIRT stated it had entered its operational phase | Second annual edition (published 2026-04-11, covering calendar 2025): 1,701,883 cyber-attack events (up about 37% on 2024) and 2,231,970 vulnerabilities recorded; five ransomware victims (Akira, Radar, Everest, INC Ransom); NAM-CSIRT states it completed Phase 3 of its three-year implementation plan in FY2025/26, marking full operationalisation, and states in its own text that it cannot fully execute its mandate absent a cybersecurity law | ADVANCED                              |
| <b>National computer security incident response team</b>                        | Operating under the regulator, publishing quarterly newsletters and an annual landscape report; about US\$1m allocated to cybersecurity for 2026/27                                                                                                                                                                          | Operating under the regulator, publishing quarterly newsletters and an annual landscape report; about US\$1m allocated to cybersecurity for 2026/27; NAM-CSIRT joined FIRST, the SADC SR-CIRT Task Force and AfricaCERT during 2025 and established the Namibia Cyber Security Information Sharing Group                                                                                                                                                  | ADVANCED                              |
| <b>National Cybersecurity Incident Management Guidelines 2026</b>               | Did not exist                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | In force since April 2026, setting out detection, reporting and coordinated response; detected vulnerabilities rose 39.8% in the following quarter                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | ADVANCED                              |
| <b>Public-service cyber training partnership</b>                                | Did not exist                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | A framework for joint training of public servants, extending to private-sector professionals; no funding, cohort size or delivery date published                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | ADVANCED                              |
| <b>Regulator and chamber of commerce memorandum</b>                             | Did not exist                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | A three-year memorandum with a joint steering committee covering public key infrastructure, cybersecurity, electronic trade facilitation, regulatory standards, legislative reform, digital literacy and capacity building; no funding, deliverables or milestones published                                                                                                                                                                              | ADVANCED                              |
| <b>Regulator as root certification authority</b>                                | The ministry accrediting electronic-signature service providers under the 2019 statute                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | The regulator states it is the national root certification authority, anchoring the digital trust framework and regulating certificate and certification-service providers                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | ADVANCED                              |
| <b>India cyber security memorandum</b>                                          | Signed July 2025, alongside an entrepreneurship centre agreement                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | No implementation activity, funding or programme reported since                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | NO CHANGE                             |

The refusal is the movement. At 30 June 2025 the satellite operator's application was pending with a ministerial exemption from the ownership rule under review; by 22 June 2026 the licence and spectrum had been declined and every reconsideration dismissed, the operator's own late request among them ([regulator account](#)). The ownership requirement itself did not change.

Three network positions advanced. Commercial fifth-generation service went from none in June 2025 to live in three centres by the end of August ([cabinet account](#)); a privately owned mobile network went from announced to launched on 2 September 2025; and 25 towers were inaugurated across nine regions ([tower account](#)).

The measured position that worsened is cyber. Detected vulnerabilities and events rose 39.8% and 56.7% quarter on quarter in the second quarter of 2026, on top of a 37% year-on-year rise across calendar 2025 ([regulator account](#)). The national data centre directed by cabinet in September 2025 has no site, capacity, cost or date at either end of the window.

## Digital public infrastructure

### Data Exchange

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                   | AT 2025-08-01                                   | AT 2026-08-21                                                    | MOVEMENT                       |
|----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| Governmental interoperability solution | Delivered 2016; no operational status published | <a href="#">No operational status published at 2026-08-06</a>    | NO CHANGE, LAST STATEMENT 2016 |
| Inter-ministry data-exchange platform  | Being deployed                                  | <a href="#">No record since 2025-09-03</a>                       | NO CHANGE, NO LATER RECORD     |
| National data exchange service bus     | In operation per a 2020 case study              | <a href="#">No operational statement published at 2026-08-06</a> | NO CHANGE, LAST STATEMENT 2020 |

### Digital Identity and CRVS

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                          | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                     | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | MOVEMENT          |
|-----------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| Electronic identity fee schedule              | None published                                                                                    | <a href="#">Free at the point of issue for first-time applicants, renewals of expired cards, amendments and holders replacing cards carrying errors; a first duplicate costs N\$150 and a second N\$300</a>                                                                                                                          | ADVANCED          |
| Electronic identity public awareness campaign | The campaign opened in Khomas; a conference on digital legal identity held in Windhoek 2025-06-26 | <a href="#">Regional outreach by home affairs with a development agency and the regulator, with a brand ambassador running sessions in local languages</a>                                                                                                                                                                           | ADVANCED          |
| National electronic identity card             | A launch announced for July 2026; card design, fees and number scheme unpublished                 | <a href="#">A September 2026 rollout confirmed; a chipped card holding biometric and biographical data plus a digital identity component for remote authentication, carrying a thumbprint, a facial image and a PIN issued as on a bank card, and valid for 10 years against the indefinite lifespan of the document it replaces</a> | ADVANCED, SLIPPED |
| Randomly generated identity number            | Identity numbers derived from date of birth; no change on record                                  | <a href="#">A random number for first-time applicants, with legacy numbers retained on the reverse of the card and existing documents valid until withdrawn by gazette notice</a>                                                                                                                                                    | ADVANCED          |
| School-based identity registration drive      | Did not exist                                                                                     | <a href="#">Officials return to each school to hand printed documents to learners rather than requiring a ministry visit</a>                                                                                                                                                                                                         | ADVANCED          |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                        | AT 2025-08-01                                       | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                     | MOVEMENT                 |
|---------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| Identity card for refugees                  | Issuing since June 2024, no annual figure published | 682 cards issued in calendar 2025                                                                                                                                                 | NO CHANGE                |
| Identity documents issued in calendar 2025  | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                            | 117,175 national identity documents, 126,737 birth certificates and 682 refugee cards issued in 2025                                                                              | Baseline not held        |
| Printed identity documents left uncollected | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                            | 166,237 printed, 125,999 collected and 40,238 uncollected, about a quarter of the print run                                                                                       | Baseline not held        |
| Youth e-ID Ambassadors Programme            | Baseline not held                                   | A programme using young people to promote take-up of the electronic identity and civic participation; participant numbers, cost, duration and any enrolment effect are not stated | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> |

## Digital Payments and Fintech

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                           | AT 2025-08-01                                                                              | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                         | MOVEMENT                   |
|----------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| Declaration of intent on instant payments integration          | Did not exist                                                                              | Signed to integrate instant payments with the national clearing infrastructure through the interbank settlement system; no deliverables, funding or timetable published                                               | ADVANCED                   |
| Instant Payment Solution                                       | In build; core-banking integration tested and user-acceptance testing under way            | Operational from June 2026 after a live pilot, with a phased national rollout and government-to-person social grants the first use case                                                                               | ADVANCED                   |
| Interbank settlement system                                    | In operation; no migration on record                                                       | Migrated to the ISO 20022 messaging standard                                                                                                                                                                          | ADVANCED                   |
| National Payment System Strategy 2021-2025                     | In force, in its final year                                                                | The period closed at an 87% average implementation rate, succeeded by a payments vision to 2030                                                                                                                       | CLOSED                     |
| National Payment System Vision 2030                            | The 2021-2025 strategy in force in its final year; no successor on record                  | Named as the successor frame with its next phase in drafting; priorities are interoperable instant payments, the quick-response standard, open banking and cyber resilience; no document held                         | ADVANCED                   |
| UnionPay e-commerce acceptance                                 | A Standard Bank and UnionPay collaboration since 2024, with no online acceptance on record | Online acceptance open to participating merchants, settling in local currency, US dollars or both                                                                                                                     | ADVANCED                   |
| Cash assistance to refugees through mobile money               | Operating; the agency reported holding 40% of the resources needed                         | No record since February 2025                                                                                                                                                                                         | NO CHANGE, NO LATER RECORD |
| Participation in the pan-African payment and settlement system | Integration being pursued, not live                                                        | No record of Namibian participation at 2026-08-06                                                                                                                                                                     | NO CHANGE                  |
| Payment System Management Act 14 of 2023                       | In force                                                                                   | In force; the payments association moved from a management council to a management board under it during 2025                                                                                                         | NO CHANGE                  |
| National quick-response payment standard                       | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                                                                   | The standard finalised, with operationalisation named a priority under the payments vision to 2030; no live deployment reported                                                                                       | Baseline not held          |
| Open banking specifications                                    | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                                                                   | Completed, with implementation named a priority under the payments vision to 2030 and no implementation date published                                                                                                | Baseline not held          |
| Transfer of payment-provider licensing to the central bank     | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                                                                   | Licensing and supervision to move to the central bank, with the association given independent governance, its own funding model and a management board; no instrument, commencement date or transition plan published | Baseline not held          |

## Registries (population, land, address, etc.)

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                          | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                                           | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                        | MOVEMENT                               |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| <b>Business and intellectual property online registration</b> | Online registration services offered                                                                                    | Online registration services offered; no transaction or uptake figure published                                                                                                      | NO CHANGE                              |
| <b>Civil Registration and Identification Act 13 of 2024</b>   | In force as the statutory basis for a single civil register, a unique identity number and identity-data confidentiality | Unchanged; read by officials on 2026-07-25 as permitting institutions to accept either the physical card or its digital version, with disclosure conditional on the holder's consent | NO CHANGE                              |
| <b>Civil registration department budget</b>                   | N\$178,122,000 for 2025/26, about US\$9.7m at the publisher's 2025 conversion                                           | No 2026/27 civil-registration allocation on file at 2026-08-06                                                                                                                       | NO CHANGE, NO 2026/27 FIGURE PUBLISHED |
| <b>National population registration system</b>                | Operating; a 2021 baseline found obsolete software, siloed databases and little interoperability                        | Operating, with remote biometric enrolment tested through hand-held devices                                                                                                          | NO CHANGE                              |

## Sectoral management information systems (HMIS, EMIS, etc.)

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                         | AT 2025-08-01                                                                           | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | MOVEMENT                     |
|--------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------|
| <b>Digital Community System for community health workers</b> | None published; the base carried only the national electronic health strategy 2021-2025 | A mobile application for community health workers in preparation, with phased deployment and paper and digital running in parallel                                                                                                                                                                                                            | ADVANCED                     |
| <b>National Digital Health Policy 2026-2036</b>              | Did not exist                                                                           | Launched 2026-02-06 as a ten-year framework developed by the health ministry with World Health Organization technical support, naming interoperability across health information systems, service delivery, governance and evidence-based decision-making as the problem it addresses; no funding, implementation plan or target is published | ADVANCED                     |
| <b>National eHealth Strategy 2021-2025</b>                   | In force, in its final year                                                             | The period expired 2025-12-31 and a successor policy was launched 2026-02-06                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | CLOSED, NO SUCCESSOR ON FILE |

## Other GovTech and e-Gov

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                 | AT 2025-08-01                                                                   | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                         | MOVEMENT  |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>Legally recognised electronic signatures</b>                      | Accreditation of service providers under way, deployment targeted February 2026 | No launch on record at 2026-08-06; the capability is now described as a component of the September 2026 identity card | STALLED   |
| <b>Digital Government Strategic Roadmap 2024-2026</b>                | In force over its 2024-2026 period; no coverage figure on record                | In force; no digital-identity coverage figure published, and card issuance begins only in September 2026              | NO CHANGE |
| <b>Target of full digitisation of government services by 2029/30</b> | Target stated; no delivery measure published                                    | Target unchanged; no delivery measure published at 2026-08-06                                                         | NO CHANGE |



## Rural digital data capture

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                  | AT 2025-08-01                                             | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                 | MOVEMENT |
|-------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>Satellite connectivity partnership with Angola</b> | A proof of concept under way; discussions began June 2025 | A pilot commercial agreement between the state fixed operator and Angola's space agency, with full commercial launch targeted after the pilot | ADVANCED |

## Digitalisation of sub-national government

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                         | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                        | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | MOVEMENT |
|--------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>Windhoek People-Centred Smart City Strategy 2026-2036</b> | Smart-city development under discussion; no strategy, financing or instrument published (2025-09-23) | Adopted 2026-06-15 and handed over in partnership with UN-Habitat and the United Nations Innovation Technology Accelerator for Cities; the named projects are commercialisation of the city's own fibre-optic network as the digital backbone and a proposed commuter rail linking Windhoek, Katutura and Rehoboth; no funding requirement, implementation timetable or institutional owner is published, and a Chinese contribution to the pilot was acknowledged 2026-07-08 | ADVANCED |

## National statistics

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                            | AT 2025-08-01                             | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | MOVEMENT  |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>Namibia Statistics Agency Strategic Plan 2022/23-2026/27</b> | Did not exist                             | In force for 2022/23-2026/27: four strategic focus areas - statistical coordination (including National Spatial Data Infrastructure coordination), sustainability (adequate government funding), institutional reform and innovation (including alternative data sources), and professionalism; the plan states funding was relatively adequate until about 2016 and records the population census slipping from August 2021 and again from August 2022 for want of funds                                                                                                                                                                                                        | ADVANCED  |
| <b>National strategy for the development of statistics</b>      | Did not exist                             | In force covering 2023/24-2026/27: four goals - better use of statistics for policy, efficient and effective data processes, a better funded national statistics system, and improved statistical integration with spatial data - resting on ten first-phase sector statistics plans (education, environment, tourism, the revenue authority, child care and protection, health, industrial development, labour, agriculture and the NSA itself); total implementation cost N\$58,995,000 over four years off a 2019 baseline, drafted with AfDB, Paris21, UNDP and UNFPA support and stated to be aimed at improving Namibia's World Bank Statistical Capacity Indicator rating | ADVANCED  |
| <b>Statistics agency microdata catalogue and data portals</b>   | Did not exist                             | NSA operates a Data Portals page (Namibia Data Portal, National Summary Data, Geo Portal, mobile application, SCAN ICT, COVID-19 dashboard) and a NADA-based microdata catalogue holding 16 Namibian studies from 1992 to 2023, each carrying a stated access term (open data access, public use data files, direct data access, or external repository); this is agency-run data dissemination, not a government-wide open data policy or portal                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | ADVANCED  |
| <b>Statistics Awareness Day</b>                                 | Did not exist                             | The inaugural event held 2026-07-27, themed statistics in the digital age                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | ADVANCED  |
| <b>2023 population and housing census</b>                       | Completed; the reference population count | Still the reference count, cited by the statistics agency as a step in modernising the national statistical system                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | NO CHANGE |
| <b>Special data dissemination standard subscription</b>         | Subscribed                                | Subscribed                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | NO CHANGE |



## Use of satellite data

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                    | AT 2025-08-01                                | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                         | MOVEMENT                      |
|-----------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| Satellite data-receiving ground station | Did not exist                                | In operation, Namibia's first such facility, receiving remote-sensing data and operated by fourteen trained Namibians | ADVANCED                      |
| Space Science and Technology Bill       | Drafting approved in 2025; no text published | No text or introduction date published at 2026-08-06                                                                  | NO CHANGE, NO DRAFT PUBLISHED |

The identity card slipped by two months and gained a fee schedule. A July 2026 launch announced in June 2025 became a September 2026 rollout ([ministry account](#)), and the ministry confirmed on 28 July that the card is free for first-time applicants, renewals of expired cards and amendments ([costs account](#)). No card had been issued at 6 August.

Payments moved further. The instant payment solution went from a build with core-banking integration under test to operational in June 2026 with three participating institutions ([central bank account](#)), the 2021-2025 payments strategy closed at an 87% average implementation rate, and a successor vision to 2030 entered drafting ([report account](#)).

The electronic signature regime is the row marked *Stalled*: accreditation of service providers was under way in September 2025 with nationwide deployment stated for February 2026, and no source records the deployment happening ([signature account](#)). The capability is now described as a component of the September 2026 card. Three data-exchange systems named across ten years — a 2016 interoperability solution, a 2020 service bus and a 2025 inter-ministry platform — have no stated relationship, operating body or governance rules at either end.

## Governance and regulation

### Legislation and regulation

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT     | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                                                          | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | MOVEMENT           |
|--------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| Corporate Laws Bill 2025 | Did not exist                                                                                                                          | At Draft 3 and out for public comment: it consolidates and re-enacts the Companies Act with the business and intellectual property authority as registrar, and clause 114 would require every company, and every external company establishing a place of business in Namibia, to keep in Namibia a register of beneficial owners recording each owner's name, date of birth, identity-document number and residential, business, email and postal addresses; company process is routed through the Electronic Transactions Act | ADVANCED           |
| Cybercrime Bill          | No bill named on the record; enforcement relying on the electronic transactions statute, the communications statute and the penal code | Named by the minister as being finalised alongside the data protection bill; no draft published and no tabling date given                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | ADVANCED, MARGINAL |
| Data Protection Bill     | A tabling announced for September 2025, about twelve years after drafting began                                                        | Not tabled and not enacted; no data-protection statute in force at 2026-08-06                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | STALLED            |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                                                                           | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | MOVEMENT  |
|-----------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>Data Protection Bill, latest published draft</b> | The March 2022 revised draft, 59 pages and eight Parts, the last version published for comment                                                          | The March 2022 revised draft remains the last version published for comment, with the supervisory authority at its Part 2; the draft's stated objects are establishing a Data Protection Supervisory Authority with its own powers and duties, obligations on data controllers and processors, rights for data subjects, and codes of conduct; the 2020 version is held alongside it, and no later text and no tabling record has been published | NO CHANGE |
| <b>Electronic Transactions Act 2019</b>             | In force; covers electronic signatures, consumer protection and contracts but not cross-border data flow, data localisation or personal data protection | Unchanged; still the interim instrument law enforcement relies on for cybercrime, with the communications statute and the penal code                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | NO CHANGE |

## Strategies, plans and policies

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                             | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                              | MOVEMENT                 |
|--------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| <b>Artificial-intelligence legislation</b>       | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | Announced as following the strategy; nothing drafted or tabled                                                                                                                                                             | <i>Baseline not held</i> |
| <b>National artificial-intelligence strategy</b> | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | Under development through the research council's working group and its technical advisory committees, with consultations begun; no draft published, and the ministry states the strategy is sequenced ahead of legislation | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

## Regional collaboration

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                         | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | MOVEMENT                 |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| <b>Namibia's seat on an international artificial-intelligence commission</b> | Did not exist            | The ICT minister is one of eight Africans on a 44-member commission                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | ADVANCED                 |
| <b>Namibia-Angola information technology and media memorandum</b>            | Did not exist            | Covers joint events, exchange of expertise and cybersecurity; no amount or instrument named                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | ADVANCED                 |
| <b>Namibia-Botswana information and communications technology memorandum</b> | Did not exist            | Signed at Kasane on 7 August 2026 between the two ICT ministries with their operators and regulators, covering digital transformation, cybersecurity, connectivity and skills development; the two sides costed the Trans-Kalahari Corridor's remaining 4G gaps at about N\$52 million across 13 new sites, recorded the completion of a Gobabis-Buitepos fibre link now interconnecting with the Botswana backbone company at Charles Hill as the first direct cross-border fibre link between the operators, and said their two incident-response teams are deepening cooperation | ADVANCED                 |
| <b>Namibia-Republic of Congo information technology memorandum</b>           | Did not exist            | Approved at cabinet's 22nd and 23rd sittings with the ICT minister authorised to sign; no scope, sector detail, financing or signature date published                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | ADVANCED                 |
| <b>Pan-African language artificial-intelligence initiative</b>               | Did not exist            | Namibia one of five backing governments in a pan-African African-language initiative scaling an existing national model template; no Namibian funding, dataset or deliverable published                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | ADVANCED                 |
| <b>Regional regulators' legal and policy committee</b>                       | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | Constituted and meeting, with artificial-intelligence governance, data governance and protection, digital public infrastructure and regional regulatory harmonisation on its agenda                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

## Data protection

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                              | AT 2025-08-01                                                             | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | MOVEMENT  |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>Gazette notice withdrawing existing identity documents</b>     | Did not exist                                                             | Named by the home affairs ministry as the instrument that will end the validity of pre-independence cards, older identity documents and current machine-readable cards; not issued                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | ADVANCED  |
| <b>Data-subject rights provisions of the Data Protection Bill</b> | Recorded as removed on a research institute's account; neither draft held | Established from the drafts themselves: the 2020 version carries Part III, "Rights of the Data Subject", sections 8 to 14, together with Part VII on recourse to the judicial authority and Part VIII on offences and penalties, none of which appears in the 59-page, eight-Part version the ministry published for comment in March 2022, where access and correction survive only as controller obligations at sections 31 and 32 | NO CHANGE |

## Public debate and participation in policymaking

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                       | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | MOVEMENT |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>Published draft and consultation record of the Data Protection Bill</b> | Did not exist | A dated consultation record: the ministry opened public input on the draft Data Protection Bill on 2022-10-26 with a closing date of 2022-11-30, addressed to two named ministry officers; the ACTION Namibia Coalition filed a submission on the closing date, compiled by ALT Advisory and funded by the Embassy of Finland through IPPR's Democracy Report project; IPPR published the same argument as a public paper on 2022-12-14, arguing the sections on the Supervisory Authority's independence need substantial redrafting and that offences and penalties provisions are undeveloped; no ministry-published list of respondents is held, and no further consultation activity is on record since | ADVANCED |

## EU activities

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                              | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                 | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | MOVEMENT  |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>European Union Multi-Annual Indicative Programme 2021-2027</b> | In force; EUR 26,000,000 indicative for 2025-2027, with nil for foundational skills education | In force with no digital priority area: digitalisation is listed as a cross-cutting priority, the named digital offer is support to the Namibian Parliament's e-Parliament blueprint, and the 2025-2027 allocation set at the mid-term review is EUR 26,000,000 - inclusive green growth 20, good governance and gender equality 2, support measures 4, foundational skills education nil | NO CHANGE |

## Open data

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                        | AT 2025-08-01          | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | MOVEMENT                          |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| <b>Access to Information Act 8 of 2022 and the Information Commissioner</b> | Gazetted, not in force | Gazetted and not commenced: section 86 leaves commencement to a date determined by the Minister, no commencement notice is held, and no Information Commissioner has been appointed; appointment machinery was itself gazetted 2024-12-09 under section 6(9), setting five-year Selection Committee terms and a five-member quorum, made ahead of the Act's own commencement, so the annual report required by section 18 cannot yet exist | ADVANCED, ACT STILL NOT COMMENCED |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                    | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | MOVEMENT                 |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| CityMender infrastructure reporting platform                            | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | A free application taking public reports of more than thirty kinds of infrastructure and service-delivery fault onto a mapped national dataset, with automatic facial and licence-plate redaction                                                                                                    | <i>Baseline not held</i> |
| Multilateral Environmental Agreements monitoring and reporting platform | Not held                 | Launched by the environment ministry at N\$12m, built with UNDP and funded by the Global Environment Facility under a land-governance project, to centralise environmental data for planning, decision-making and national reporting, with the national university as technical and academic partner | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> |

Both headline bills missed their stated dates. The Data Protection Bill was announced in August 2025 for tabling in September 2025 and was still being finalised in July 2026 ([ministerial account](#)); the Cybercrime Bill entered the record only on 13 July 2026, as another instrument being finalised.

Around them the administrative machinery advanced. The national ICT policy and the ministry's strategic plan were launched at Opuwo on 29 January 2026 ([launch account](#)), incident management guidelines were issued in April 2026, a government-sector response team was approved by cabinet in November 2025 ([cabinet account](#)), and two memoranda were signed with a public administration institute and a chamber of commerce.

That is the shape of the period: five instruments of guidance and cooperation made, and no statute. The gazette notice that would withdraw existing identity documents has not issued, so the September rollout is additive to a document estate that includes pre-independence cards.

## Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

### AI

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                          | AT 2025-08-01                                                              | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | MOVEMENT                 |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| Artificial-intelligence readiness assessment                  | Completed (2025)                                                           | Completed; the findings were restated by the research council's authors on 2026-02-16                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | <b>NO CHANGE</b>         |
| Artificial-intelligence working group of the research council | Operating; contributed to the artificial-intelligence readiness assessment | Operating; runs the national strategy process                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | <b>NO CHANGE</b>         |
| National artificial-intelligence institute                    | Proposed, not established                                                  | Proposed, not established; no site, budget, host or founding instrument on file                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | <b>NO CHANGE</b>         |
| Artificial-intelligence agricultural monitoring contract      | Not held                                                                   | A one-year contract with a United States firm at N\$39.5m, about US\$2.4m, introducing satellite imagery, remote sensing and artificial-intelligence monitoring of mahangu, maize, sorghum, cowpea and wheat; the agriculture ministry says Namibia retains ownership of the satellite and crop data generated and will receive model and skills transfer. The award drew public objection over transparency and local participation | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> |
| Indigenous-language voice-data repository                     | Baseline not held                                                          | A voice-data repository for Namibian indigenous languages being built through the development programme's artificial-intelligence sprint with the national science and technology university; no language count, corpus size, licence or release date is stated                                                                                                                                                                      | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> |

## ICT Industry

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                | AT 2025-08-01                                   | AT 2026-08-21                                                         | MOVEMENT  |
|-----------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Space Science and Technology Bill drafting approval | Drafting approved by cabinet; no text published | Drafting approved; no bill, text or timetable published at 2026-08-06 | NO CHANGE |

## Innovation ecosystem

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                        | AT 2025-08-01                    | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                 | MOVEMENT          |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| University artificial-intelligence and robotics accelerator | Operating (2025, year precision) | Operating; supports bachelor's and honours degrees in artificial intelligence and a master's in data science                  | NO CHANGE         |
| Information technology venture capital fund                 | BASELINE NOT HELD                | Authorised at US\$20m; no fund manager, first close, instrument, Namibian-dollar figure or disbursement on file at 2026-08-06 | Baseline not held |

## US / hyperscaler activities

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT               | AT 2025-08-01     | AT 2026-08-21                                                                        | MOVEMENT  |
|------------------------------------|-------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Subsea cable landing at Swakopmund | In service (2022) | In service; cited as the connectivity leg of the case for hosting compute in Namibia | NO CHANGE |

## China activities

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                  | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                         | MOVEMENT |
|-------------------------------------------------------|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Chinese contribution to the Windhoek smart city pilot | Did not exist | CNY 98,000,000 committed, about US\$14.4m on the source's 2026 conversion, for digital infrastructure, artificial-intelligence capability and skills under the ten-year city strategy | ADVANCED |

## India activities

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                          | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | MOVEMENT          |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| PARAM HPC cluster at NUST                                     | Did not exist | A 5-node C-DAC PARAM HPC cluster (17.7 TF Rpeak, 5,320 cores, 480 GB memory, 100 TB storage plus 54 TB backup) specified for deployment at NUST, Windhoek, under the India-Namibia Centre of Excellence in Information Technology; no operator, cost or opening date is published, and this is a university research cluster, not a national facility | ADVANCED          |
| India bilateral cybersecurity and digital-economy cooperation | Not held      | Advanced at the fourth joint trade committee in New Delhi on 12 August 2026, building on a memorandum signed by the two heads of government in July 2025; bilateral trade is put at more than US\$592m in 2025/26                                                                                                                                     | BASELINE NOT HELD |

## Gulf/UAE activities

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                       | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | MOVEMENT |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>Gulf-state digital or artificial-intelligence cooperation agreement</b> | Did not exist | Proposed only: a Bilateral Economic Commission with technology transfer, skills development, industrialisation and manufacturing in its remit; the UAE side raised investment protection and double-taxation agreements; no Gulf-state digital, data-centre or artificial-intelligence agreement is published at 2026-08-09 | ADVANCED |

The strategy went from absent to in consultation. In February 2026 the research council's own authors wrote that Namibia lacks a national artificial-intelligence strategy and lacks comprehensive legislation for data protection and cybersecurity ([council paper](#)); by 3 August the ministry stated consultations had begun and that legislation is sequenced behind the strategy ([ministerial account](#)).

Two objects entered the record that did not exist at the start of the window: the satellite data-receiving ground station handed over on 12 February 2026, stated to be wholly Namibia-run ([handover account](#)), and founding partnership in a pan-African language artificial-intelligence initiative launched on 24 July 2026 ([launch account](#)).

Two did not move. A national artificial-intelligence institute recommended by a 2022 task force is proposed and unestablished at both ends, and the venture capital fund authorised by cabinet in September 2025 has no manager, first close, instrument or disbursement on record ([cabinet account](#)).

## Inclusion and capacity

### Digital divides

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                               | AT 2025-08-01                                                             | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | MOVEMENT                             |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| <b>Regulator sector and market report series</b>                   | Published; four editions on file, the latest reporting 2023 data          | Published as an irregular series - an earlier Telecommunication Sector Market Report in October 2021, the Telecommunication Sector Market Report 2021 in November 2022, the ICT Sector Market Report 2022 in December 2023 and the ICT Sector Market Report 2023 in November 2024 - built on licensees' audited financial statements and the regulator's own portal data | NO CHANGE                            |
| <b>Schools and health facilities without adequate connectivity</b> | 339 schools and 50 health centres lacking adequate connectivity (2025-06) | No later official figure; a research council account records 65.4% of schools connected in 2023, 1,311 of 2,004                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | NO CHANGE, NO LATER FIGURE PUBLISHED |

### Access to services

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                          | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                     | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                | MOVEMENT                      |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| <b>Financial inclusion rate</b>                               | 78%, described as current by an industry executive (2025-07)                                      | 86% (2025), with the same 78% dated to 2017                                                                                                                  | ADVANCED, DATING UNRECONCILED |
| <b>Free internet for schools and clinics under new towers</b> | Not on record; 339 schools and 50 health centres reported without adequate connectivity (2025-06) | Free internet for seven years to schools and clinics under towers built in the previous two years; N\$80m in nine radio access network towers over two years | ADVANCED                      |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                            | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                            | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                  | MOVEMENT          |
|-------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| <b>100% telecommunications coverage by 2030</b> | Target announced; about 360,000 people, roughly 12%, outside fourth-generation coverage at February 2024 | Target unchanged; no later official coverage figure held, and the sixth national development plan carries a parallel internet-use target of 53% to 90% by 2030 | NO CHANGE         |
| <b>Namibia Learning Passport</b>                | Not held                                                                                                 | Launched by the education ministry with UNICEF as a digital and offline learning platform aimed at rural, remote and underserved young people                  | BASELINE NOT HELD |
| <b>School connectivity in Kavango West</b>      | BASELINE NOT HELD                                                                                        | 21 of the region's 188 schools have workable connectivity, leaving 55,002 learners without digital teaching tools (2026-08)                                    | Baseline not held |

## Literacy

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                 | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                                                                                                          | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | MOVEMENT |
|------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>Information and Communication school syllabus</b> | In implementation; the senior secondary Grade 12 syllabus was published in 2018 by the education ministry's national institute for educational development, for implementation in 2021 | In implementation across Grades 8, 9 and 12 at least: Information and Communication is a compulsory, non-promotional but assessable subject for Grade 4-12, run across three themes - Digital Literacy, Media Literacy and Information Literacy; the Grade 12 syllabus was published in 2018 for 2021 implementation and the Grade 8 & 9 syllabus in December 2024 for phased implementation in 2025 and 2026; no standalone national digital-literacy strategy or programme exists outside this curriculum | ADVANCED |

## Training and skills

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                      | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                        | MOVEMENT |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|---------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>Government technology staff cyber-skills programme</b> | Did not exist | Cabinet-approved targeted training in cyber hygiene, incident response and threat intelligence; no delivery, budget or cohort reported at 2026-08-06 | ADVANCED |

The one movement the state itself measures is financial inclusion, from 78% in 2017 to 86% in 2025 ([central bank account](#)) — a series whose earlier value a second held source described as current in July 2025, eight years out.

Connectivity commitments were restated rather than delivered against. The 100% coverage target for 2030 stands unchanged with no later official coverage figure ([ministry account](#)), the tax-relief proposal on fourth-generation devices made in February 2026 has produced no fiscal instrument or ministerial response, and the free-internet undertaking for schools and clinics under new towers still has no list or count of covered sites.

## Finance

### New investments

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                     | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-21                                                                               | MOVEMENT |
|------------------------------------------|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>Private mobile network investment</b> | Did not exist | A live network with N\$600,000,000 invested in the year to September 2025, company-reported | ADVANCED |



| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT          | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                                                                                                                | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | MOVEMENT                              |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| <b>Universal service levy</b> | A 2022 notice of intention (Government Gazette 7860, General Notice 342, 25 July 2022) withdrawn<br>2024-06-21 (Government Gazette 8384, General Notice 291) pending a revised evidence base | In force from 2024-09-27: levy not exceeding 0.5% of annual turnover per licensee (regulation 4 and Annexure A), a flat N\$500 floor for non-profit licensees, invoiced on audited or sworn financial statements and payable within 30 days into the Universal Service Fund; regulation 9 and Annexure B amended the 2018 universal service regulations to let the Fund receive donations or grants, which is what makes the Government of Namibia's committed funding receivable; CRAN's own reply to comments states the Gap Analysis identifies 119 locations that will remain unserved after 700/800 MHz roll-out obligations, of which government funding covers the capital cost of 42                               | ADVANCED                              |
| <b>Universal Service Fund</b> | Operating; N\$145,000,000 of seed funding over three years and a N\$31,000,000 subsidy already disbursed to the mobile operator for nine network sites (2025-03)                             | Operating; priority given to the five regions where 4G coverage is below 80% - Kavango West, Kavango East, Kunene, Ohangwena and Oshikoto - with 16 schools and four clinics selected for uncapped Wi-Fi, and 100 handsets distributed to learners in Kunene in February 2026, and CRAN's own Integrated Annual Report 2025 states the Fund's governance framework was developed and approved by the CRAN Board, with the Ministry's contribution given there as N\$115,000,000 over three years and a first bidding round awarding nine sites to MTC with almost N\$31,000,000 of capital subsidy across the same five regions, all schools and health facilities on those sites to receive free internet for seven years | NO CHANGE, FUNDING TOTAL UNRECONCILED |

Two financing commitments entered the record within the window. The private mobile network reported N\$600m invested in the year to September 2025 ([launch account](#)), and China committed CNY 98,000,000, about US\$14.4m on the source's 2026 conversion, to the Windhoek smart-city pilot, acknowledged at the end of June 2026 ([Presidency account](#)). The Universal Service Fund published no accounts at either end of the window.

## Where the record is thin

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                   | WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | LAST PROBED |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| <b>Consultancy engagement on the artificial-intelligence framework</b> | A procurement award notice, terms of reference or signed advisory agreement; the base carries two accounts of a 2026-08-03 meeting and the minister's statement that the research council leads, and no contract, scope of work, procurement route or value, with none listed on the central procurement board                                                                                                                    | 2026-08-06  |
| <b>National high-performance computing facility</b>                    | A research council or ministry announcement, procurement notice or budget line for a national compute facility; the base carries the council's own statement that its data committee is to provide such centres and that securing computing infrastructure is a next step, and separately that a vendor is building a data centre for artificial-intelligence workloads, with no named facility, site, capacity, cost or operator | 2026-08-06  |
| <b>Start-up act</b>                                                    | A gazetted act or a published bill; a held source records that at 2026-08-09 no gazetted or tabled start-up legislation could be located and that the nearest policy instrument, the National Informal Economy, Start-ups and Entrepreneurship Development Policy, is not published at any URL, so what is outstanding is confirmation that none exists rather than a document                                                    | 2026-08-06  |
| <b>Government interoperability framework</b>                           | A published interoperability framework, standard or governing instrument; the base names three data-exchange objects across ten years and establishes no relationship between them, no operating body and no governance rules                                                                                                                                                                                                     | 2026-08-06  |
| <b>Payments association 2025 annual report</b>                         | The report itself; the base holds two press accounts of its 2026-07-28 release and no primary, and the association's own site publishes only a memorandum and a board release, so four payment rows stand on press reporting of one unheld document                                                                                                                                                                               | 2026-08-06  |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                                             | WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | LAST PROBED |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| <b>National open data policy or government portal</b>                                            | A portal address, a dataset catalogue or a policy document; the subject holds nothing for Namibia, and the nearest held material is central bank and statistics agency statements on administrative data, which concern data quality rather than publication                                                                             | 2026-08-06  |
| <b>Published draft and consultation record of the Data Protection Bill</b>                       | A ministry consultation notice, submissions register or committee record; the base carries only two sources on this subject and a researcher's statement that the public had not seen the latest draft at 2025-08-17                                                                                                                     | 2026-08-06  |
| <b>Smart-city grant agreement and annexures</b>                                                  | The signed grant agreement, its annexures, the contractor list and the data architecture; the base carries an opposition member's characterisation and a presidential acknowledgement of the amount, with no instrument text, and does not establish the Chinese disbursing agency                                                       | 2026-08-06  |
| <b>Ratification of the continental convention on cyber security and personal data protection</b> | The continental depositary list entry or a Namibian instrument of ratification or accession; the base carries 20 sources on this subject, all bilateral or convened by an industry body, and none names a continental or regional data-governance instrument Namibia has acceded to                                                      | 2026-08-06  |
| <b>National digital literacy programme</b>                                                       | A named ministry or regulator digital-literacy strategy, curriculum or programme document; the subject carries exactly one Namibian source, the regulator and chamber memorandum of 2026-07-30, which names digital literacy as a workstream with no funding, deliverable or target                                                      | 2026-08-06  |
| <b>Information and communications technology ministry budget vote</b>                            | The ministry's vote in the appropriation bill or its budget-vote motivation speech; the base holds no Namibian technology appropriation of any year, and the one appropriation figure held anywhere in the base is the civil registration department's, on a source tagged to other subjects                                             | 2026-08-06  |
| <b>Universal Service Fund annual accounts</b>                                                    | The fund's annual report, or the regulator's disclosure of levy receipts and project disbursements; the base establishes the fund exists, its launch month, its initial endowment and two in-kind outputs, all from secondary reporting of ministerial statements, and carries no levy rate, contribution base, receipts or project list | 2026-08-06  |
| <b>Power supply plan for the national data centre</b>                                            | A power purchase agreement, grid-connection study or energy annex to the data-centre project proposal; the subject carries one Namibian source, a signed opinion piece arguing the case for hosting compute locally, so there is no held statement of how any planned facility would be powered, at what cost, or by whom                | 2026-08-06  |

Twenty-two rows are *Not held* at both ends, and all 22 were searched on 6 August. Nineteen name published documents and three are searched absences.

The one that most constrains this report is the regulator's absent sector report. Namibia refused a licence on national-security and ownership grounds, set a 2030 coverage target and built 25 towers inside the window — and the wiki cannot state a single dated Namibian coverage or subscriber figure on the regulator's own authority, because none is published in anything held.

The second is the payments association's annual report. Four positions in the digital public infrastructure section — the quick-response standard, open banking, the settlement migration and the closing implementation rate of the 2021-2025 strategy — rest entirely on press accounts of a document the wiki does not hold, and the probe of 6 August found it published nowhere but the association's own site, which refuses automated clients.

The third is the smart-city agreement. A member of parliament asked on 4 August for its annexures, contractors, data architecture and lifetime operating costs; none of those is held, and neither is the disbursing agency.

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## ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

|                 |                                                                                                                                                                     |
|-----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
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